SAARAS KODALI

San Diego, CA
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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley Berkeley, CA
Bachelor of Arts in Economics Expected 2030

- Admitted from Del Norte High School — Weighted GPA: 4.4/4.0 (Unweighted: 3.98); SAT: 1510
- Honors: IHA National Health Literacy Conference Research Award; Trauma Transformed Leadership Award; NYAS Junior Academy Global Scholar; FRC Engineering Excellence Award; Academic League Regional Champion (1st Place)
- Relevant Coursework & Training: Applied Microeconomics, Econometrics, Behavioral Economics, Public Economics & Policy, Data Science (R/Python)

WORK & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Vantage AI (Stealth Incubator) Remote
AI & Machine Learning Intern 2024 – 2025

- Selected for an invite-only incubator led by An Luong (ex-Microsoft), Head of Data & AI, worked on building Python-based ML/LLM products across Asia
- Selected Project Experience:
  - AI-Based Market Analysis & Algorithmic Trading Engine
    - Built a proprietary sentiment-scoring model, engineered independently from FinBERT, paired with a real-time news pipeline and event-detection system to trade major tech equities (Google, Apple, and peers) ahead of market reaction
    - Designed the full signal-generation pipeline: ingesting breaking financial news, scoring sentiment and materiality in real time, and translating signals into trade decisions
    - Backtested the strategy in simulation and outperformed the S&P 500, validated that proprietary sentiment signals could generate alpha beyond standard NLP baselines that were tested simultaneously

EquityPlay — Economic Inequality Simulation San Diego, CA
Founder & Lead Developer 2023 – Present

- Built a full-stack financial dashboard used by students to model how personal decisions intersect with systemic economic inequality
- Integrated 30,000+ data points from U.S. Census, BLS, HUD, and FRED into a React/Python/Firebase platform to model wealth accumulation and debt risk by race, gender, and geography
- Designed interactive policy toggles (UBI, FAFSA reform, wage subsidies) with time-series projections; piloted the tool in youth financial-literacy workshops

Open Coding Society San Diego, CA
Founder & Lead Developer 2022 – Present

- Founded and lead a 16+ member student software organization building collaborative coding projects and peer-led technical training
- Directed development of a 2D financial-simulation game (Java, SQLite, JavaScript), owning database design, version control, and UI/UX

Global Initiatives Alliance Statewide, CA
Co-Executive Director; Director of Research 2023 – Present

- Lead a statewide youth policy and advocacy network spanning public health, education, and economic-equity projects
- Manage research coordination and nonprofit partnerships to translate findings into actionable community programs

Case Study Initiative San Diego, CA
President; Economic Case Study Research Lead 2023 – Present

- Lead peer research teams analyzing major economic and tech-driven events, including the macroeconomic impact of Trump-era tariffs and the financial fallout of the CrowdStrike outage

SKILLS, ACTIVITIES & INTERESTS

Technical Skills: Python, R, JavaScript, SQL, Flask, React, Firebase, Git, Plotly, D3.js

Certifications & Training: R Programming — Johns Hopkins Data Science Specialization; FTE Advanced Economics for Leaders; Econ4Everyone (University of Chicago)

Activities: $EED Financial Literacy Program (Founder); FRC Robotics (Scouting Lead); Akshaya Patra Coding Instructor; Project Flight (Vice President)